First quarter report card comments

Build each comment in four parts: **how the student has settled in**, **one or two things that have gone well**, **one goal for next quarter**, and **what you or the family will do to help**. Swap [Name] and "their" for the student's name and pronoun, and keep only what is true of this student.

Settling in

- **SETTLED IN QUICKLY** [Name] has settled quickly into our class and already knows our routines well.
- **SETTLING IN STEADILY** [Name] has settled in steadily this quarter and is growing more confident each week.
- **NEW TO THE SCHOOL** [Name] is new to our school this year and has settled in well, learning new routines and getting to know classmates.
- **ADJUSTING TO A NEW GRADE** [Name] is adjusting well to the new routines and expectations of a new grade.
- **STILL LEARNING ROUTINES** [Name] is still learning some of our routines and is more comfortable with them each week.
- **QUIET AT FIRST** [Name] was quiet in our first weeks and is starting to share more, especially in small groups.

What has gone well

Follows routines

- [Name] follows our classroom routines and is ready to learn quickly each morning.
- [Name] knows where everything goes and starts the day without reminders.

Listens and gets started

- [Name] listens carefully to instructions and gets started straight away.
- [Name] listens well in lessons and asks when something isn't clear.

Reading

- [Name] reads every day in our reading time and can retell what happened in a story.
- [Name] is building good reading habits and chooses books with care.

Writing

- [Name] is willing to have a go at writing and adds more detail each week.
- [Name] writes about their own ideas and experiences with real enthusiasm.

Math

- [Name] is confident with the number work we have covered so far and explains their thinking.
- [Name] has picked up our first math unit well and checks their answers.

Science and social studies

- [Name] brings questions and ideas to our science and social studies.
- [Name] remembers what we learned in earlier lessons and connects it to new topics.

Joins in discussions

- [Name] joins in class discussions and shares ideas with the group.
- [Name] is willing to answer questions even when unsure, which helps their learning.

Works independently

- [Name] works on their own for a little longer each week.
- [Name] organizes their own materials and keeps track of their work.

Takes care, keeps trying

- [Name] takes care over their work and finishes tasks.
- [Name] keeps trying when a task is new or hard.

Kind to classmates

- [Name] is kind to classmates and includes others in games and group work.
- [Name] works well with a partner and takes turns fairly.

Homework and reading at home

- [Name] brings their homework back on time and done with care.
- [Name] reads at home regularly, and it shows in their reading in class.

Curious about new topics

- [Name] asks thoughtful questions and is curious about each new topic.
- [Name] brings things from home to share that connect to what we are learning.

Goals for next quarter

Getting started on tasks

- **GOAL** Next quarter, [Name] will work on getting started on tasks more quickly after instructions.
- **YOU** To help with this, I'll give [Name] a short checklist for the start of each task.
- **HOME** At home, you could practice a simple morning routine with a picture or word checklist.

Focus during independent work

- **GOAL** Next quarter, [Name] will work on staying focused for longer stretches of independent work.
- **YOU** To help with this, I'll break longer tasks into smaller steps with a check-in after each one.
- **HOME** At home, you could set a timer for short bursts of homework or reading, with a break in between.

Reading aloud smoothly

- **GOAL** Next quarter, [Name] will work on reading aloud more smoothly, with fewer stops to sound out words.
- **YOU** To help with this, I'll listen to [Name] read each week and practice tricky words.
- **HOME** At home, you could read together for ten minutes most evenings, taking turns with the pages.

Understanding what they read

- **GOAL** Next quarter, [Name] will work on explaining why characters act as they do, as well as what happens in a story.
- **YOU** To help with this, I'll ask more "why" questions in our reading groups.
- **HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] why a character did something in a story you read together.

More detail in writing

- **GOAL** Next quarter, [Name] will work on adding more detail to their writing.
- **YOU** To help with this, I'll give a short checklist with one kind of detail to add each time.
- **HOME** At home, you could encourage [Name] to write a list, card or note for a real reason.

Handwriting and spacing

- **GOAL** Next quarter, [Name] will work on forming letters neatly and leaving spaces between words.
- **YOU** To help with this, I'll build in short handwriting practice each week.
- **HOME** At home, you could write shopping lists or cards together.

Number facts

- **GOAL** Next quarter, [Name] will work on recalling number facts more quickly.
- **YOU** To help with this, I'll add a few minutes of facts practice to each math lesson.
- **HOME** At home, you could play a quick number facts game in the car or at dinner.

Explaining math thinking

- **GOAL** Next quarter, [Name] will work on explaining the steps behind their answers.
- **YOU** To help with this, I'll ask for one sentence on how each answer was found.
- **HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to show you how a homework problem was solved.

Sharing ideas in class

- **GOAL** Next quarter, [Name] will work on sharing ideas in class discussions more often.
- **YOU** To help with this, I'll give notice of a question so [Name] can think of an answer first.
- **HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to tell you one thing learned at school each day.

Waiting for a turn to speak

- **GOAL** Next quarter, [Name] will work on waiting for a turn to speak in group discussions.
- **YOU** To help with this, I'll use talk partners so everyone gets a turn.
- **HOME** At home, you could take turns at dinner, with each person sharing one thing from the day.

Keeping track of things

- **GOAL** Next quarter, [Name] will work on keeping track of their own materials and homework.
- **YOU** To help with this, I'll set up a simple end-of-day checklist.
- **HOME** At home, you could pack the school bag together the night before.

Asking for help early

- **GOAL** Next quarter, [Name] will work on asking for help as soon as something isn't clear.
- **YOU** To help with this, I'll check in with [Name] early in each task.
- **HOME** At home, you could talk about a time you asked for help and how it went.

Working with different classmates

- **GOAL** Next quarter, [Name] will work on working with a wider range of classmates.
- **YOU** To help with this, I'll mix partners and groups so [Name] works with different people.
- **HOME** At home, you could ask about a classmate [Name] worked with that day.

Staying calm when work is hard

- **GOAL** Next quarter, [Name] will work on staying calm and trying again when a task feels hard.
- **YOU** To help with this, I'll teach a few calm-down steps that [Name] can use in class.
- **HOME** At home, you could name feelings together and talk about what helps.

Checking work before handing in

- **GOAL** Next quarter, [Name] will work on checking their work before handing it in.
- **YOU** To help with this, I'll give a short checklist to use before handing work in.
- **HOME** At home, you could ask [Name] to find one thing to fix in finished homework.

50 short comments

1. [Name] has settled quickly into our class and knows our routines well.
2. [Name] has settled in well and is growing more confident each week.
3. [Name] has made a positive start, joining in and trying their best.
4. [Name] is new to our school and is making friends and learning routines.
5. [Name] comes in ready to learn and starts the day without reminders.
6. [Name] listens carefully to instructions and gets started straight away.
7. [Name] asks for help when something isn't clear.
8. [Name] is building good reading habits and chooses books with care.
9. [Name] can retell the main events of a story in order.
10. [Name] reads aloud with growing confidence.
11. [Name] is willing to have a go at writing and adds more detail each week.
12. [Name] writes about their own ideas with enthusiasm.
13. [Name] is confident with the number work we have covered so far.
14. [Name] explains their math thinking clearly.
15. [Name] has made a strong start in math and checks their answers.
16. [Name] brings good questions to our science and social studies lessons.
17. [Name] joins in class discussions and shares ideas.
18. [Name] is willing to answer even when unsure, which helps their learning.
19. [Name] works on their own for a little longer each week.
20. [Name] takes care over their work and finishes tasks.
21. [Name] keeps trying when a task is new or hard.
22. [Name] is kind to classmates and includes others.
23. [Name] works well with a partner and takes turns fairly.
24. [Name] brings homework back on time and done with care.
25. [Name] is curious about each new topic and asks good questions.
26. [Name] is still learning our routines and is more settled each week.
27. [Name] was quiet at first and is starting to share more in small groups.
28. [Name] is adjusting well to the new expectations of this grade.
29. [Name] has made good progress since the start of the quarter.
30. [Name] is getting more independent with each week.
31. Next quarter, [Name] will work on getting started more quickly.
32. Next quarter, [Name] will work on focusing for longer stretches.
33. Next quarter, [Name] will work on reading aloud more smoothly.
34. Next quarter, [Name] will work on adding detail to their writing.
35. Next quarter, [Name] will work on forming letters neatly.
36. Next quarter, [Name] will work on recalling number facts quickly.
37. Next quarter, [Name] will work on explaining their answers.
38. Next quarter, [Name] will work on sharing ideas more often.
39. Next quarter, [Name] will work on waiting for a turn to speak.
40. Next quarter, [Name] will work on keeping track of their things.
41. Next quarter, [Name] will work on asking for help early.
42. Next quarter, [Name] will work on staying calm when work is hard.
43. Next quarter, [Name] will work on checking work before handing it in.
44. Next quarter, [Name] will work with a wider range of classmates.
45. Reading together for ten minutes a day at home would help [Name].
46. Playing quick number games at home would help [Name] learn their facts.
47. A checklist for packing the school bag would help [Name] stay organized.
48. I'm looking forward to the rest of the year with [Name].
49. Thank you for your support in these first weeks of the year.
50. [Name] has made a good start, and I look forward to the next quarter.

Phrases to avoid, rewritten

Instead of	Write
It's too early in the year to tell.	[Name] listens carefully to instructions and gets started straight away. Next quarter, [Name] will work on adding more detail to their writing.
Ava has had a great year!	[Name] has settled in steadily this quarter and joins in class discussions.
Ava has had a good start.	[Name] knows our routines and starts each morning without reminders.
Ava needs to settle down.	Next quarter, [Name] will work on getting started on tasks more quickly after instructions.
Ava talks too much and needs to stop talking in class.	[Name] is keen to share ideas. Next quarter, [Name] will work on waiting for a turn to speak in group discussions.
Ava can't read yet.	[Name] knows many letter sounds and is starting to blend them into words. Next quarter, [Name] will work on reading short words.
Ava is below grade level in math.	[Name] counts objects to 20 with care. Next quarter, [Name] will work on recalling number facts more quickly.
Ava won't do any work without help.	[Name] works best with a check-in at the start of a task. Next quarter, [Name] will work on getting started on tasks with less help.
Ava refuses to join in.	[Name] was quiet in our first weeks and is starting to share more in small groups.
Ava is lazy about homework.	Next quarter, [Name] will work on returning homework on time. A regular time and place at home would help.
Ava is disruptive.	Next quarter, [Name] will work on staying focused for longer stretches of independent work, with a check-in after each step.
Ava is immature for her age.	[Name] is still learning some of our routines and is more comfortable with them each week.
I don't know Ava well yet.	[Name] brings questions and ideas to our science lessons, and I'm getting to know [Name] as a learner.
Ava is a pleasure to have in class.	[Name] is kind to classmates and includes others in games and group work.
Ava is an excellent student.	[Name] has picked up our first math unit well and checks their answers.
Ava works hard.	[Name] keeps trying when a task is new or hard, and asks for help when something isn't clear.
Ava is well behaved.	[Name] follows our classroom routines and is ready to learn quickly each morning.
Ava will do great in second grade next year.	Next quarter, [Name] will work on reading aloud more smoothly, with fewer stops to sound out words.
Ava is ahead of the other children in reading.	[Name] reads every day in our reading time and can retell what happened in a story.
Ava has struggled since her parents separated.	[Name] is settling in and is more comfortable with our routines each week.
Ava may need to repeat the grade.	Next quarter, [Name] will work on recalling number facts more quickly. I'd like to meet to talk about the next steps.
Keep up the good work!	Next quarter, [Name] will work on explaining the steps behind their answers.

147 lines. Free from polytheseus.com/teacher-skills/guides/first-quarter-report-card-comments, where a free builder puts them together and checks the wording. Drafted with AI help: read every line against what you know of the student and your school's report rules before you use it.